

r/singularity

AI & Fresh Water

Posted by u/spread_the_cheese • 0 points • 29 comments

I have seen lots of posts about AI and its impact on health and aging, but less so on its work with water. Mainly, breakthroughs on the creation of fresh drinking water, which will be very needed in the coming decades.

Does anyone have info on who is working on this and their progress?

Comments

u/phoenix_down99999 • 2 points • 2023-06-04 22:12 UTC

Computing produces massive amounts of waste heat. Perfect for desalination.

u/ertgbnm • 5 points • 2023-06-04 18:23 UTC

Water has been "solved" already. We are just waiting on mass manufacturing and mass energy surpluses to make desalinization and long trek pumping economical.

It's no longer a science problem and more of an engineering problem.

Edit: I want to amend my statement. Residuals are still kind of unsolved. There seems to be some evidence that discharging your RO concentrate back to the ocean is not great for the environment. If you are inland, you only options are deep well injection or evaporation. So I think we need some innovation. Mostly logistical to solve this part.

u/SoylentRox • 4 points • 2023-06-04 17:46 UTC

Fresh water through desalination has been a solved problem for many years now. It doesn't cost much or use much energy. See : [<https://www.technologyreview.com/technology/megascale-desalination/>]
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The issues causing water shortages are:

- (1) it requires a large upfront investment for the equipment and facilities
- (2) governments have to actually spend the money on equipment and not pocket it through corruption
- (3) some areas of the world are desperately poor and even cheap desalination is more than they can afford

(4) corrupt local governments block desalination plants with specious environmental reviews/people complained. See Los Angeles deciding to prolong their water shortage by delaying desalination builds for more than 10 years.

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AI with cheap robots helps though it doesn't solve (4), fake environmental reviews will still cause delays. They are fake because the output of a desalination plant is seawater with more salt and less water.

u/Enough_Island4615 • -2 points • 2023-06-04 16:58 UTC

AI has already solved the issue. Fresh water needs can be met indefinitely by reducing the human population to 500 million.

u/ClickF0rDick • 2 points • 2023-06-04 19:27 UTC

[AI thought of that, sure]

(<https://static.wikia.nocookie.net/ethgoesboom/images/7/7d/Thaos.jpg/revision/latest?cb=20190524114931>)